

Gonzalo Ballester

Department of Economics
Pennsylvania State University

Email: gballester@psu.edu
Website: <https://ballesterogh.github.io>

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Pennsylvania State University	2022 – 2028 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, Universidad de San Andres	2020 – 2021
B.A. <i>magna cum laude</i> in Economics, Universidad de Buenos Aires	2015 – 2019

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Market Design, Economics of Artificial Intelligence

Publications

[Strategic Algorithmic Monoculture: Experimental Evidence from Coordination Games](#), with Hadi Hosseini, Samarth Khanna, and Ran I. Shorrer. *Proceedings of the 27th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC' 26)*, Extended Abstract. [arXiv 2604.09502](#)

[Algorithmic Collusion under Sequential Pricing and Stochastic Costs](#). *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, June 2026. [SSRN 5203084](#)

Working Papers

Centralized Admission Mechanisms and International Migration

The Pitfalls of Preferential Admission Policies

Publications Prior to PhD

A Regulatory Framework for Nanotechnology in Argentina (*in Spanish*), with Pablo Herrera and Javier García Fronti, *Nanotecnología y Sociedad en Argentina*. Vol. I, pp. 183-200, 2021

A Note on the Kuhn-Tucker Theorem: Revisiting Constraint Qualifications (*in Spanish*), with Pablo Herrera, *Revista de Investigación en Modelos Matemáticos Aplicados a la Gestión y la Economía*, Vol. II (6) pp. 23-34, 2019

Policy Briefs

Cheating in the Medical Residency Entrance Exam (*in Spanish*), July 2025

Redesigning the Medical Match in Argentina: Toward More Equitable Access (*in Spanish*), with Mariana Gudiño and Nahir Lera, June 2025. Featured in *Clarín*, *La Nación*, *Penn State News*

Seminar and Conference Presentations

2026: ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC'26) (scheduled); ESIF Conference on Economics and AI+ML at Cornell University (scheduled); EARIE at University of Mannheim (scheduled); Universidad de San Andres; Peruvian Medical Society; AI and the Economy Initiative Inaugural Workshop at Penn State; Penn State Applied Micro Brown Bag ($\times 2$).

2025: Midwest Economic Theory Conference at Virginia Tech, Ministry of Health of Argentina;

CSRAI Young Achievers Symposium; Penn State Applied Micro Brown Bag ($\times 2$); Penn State Trade and Development Brown Bag; Penn State Theory Lunch.

2024: Summer School EARIE at the University of Amsterdam; Pennsylvania Economic Theory Conference (Poster Presentation); Penn State Theory Lunch; Penn State Applied Micro Brown Bag.

2021: LVI Annual Meeting of the Argentine Association of Political Economy; Summer School at Zurich University of Applied Sciences.

Professional Activities

Co-Organizer of the AI and the Economy Initiative, Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Professional Development

Summer School in AI and Economics, Chicago Booth, 2026

Summer School in Market Design, EARIE, 2026

Summer School in Dynamic Structural Econometrics, Econometric Society, 2025

Summer School in AI and Industrial Organization, EARIE, 2024

Research Experience

Research Assistant for Prof. Hadi Hosseini, Pennsylvania State University	2026
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Research Assistant for Prof. Ran I. Shorrer, Pennsylvania State University	2024 – 2025
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Research Assistant for Prof. M. Florencia Gabrielli, Universidad de San Andres	2021 – 2022
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Research Assistant for Prof. Pablo Herrera, Universidad de Buenos Aires	2018 – 2020
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Awards, Honors, Fellowships, and Grants

Fox Scholarly & Professional Impact Award (USD 10,000), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Edward J. Green Graduate Fund (USD 1,000), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Travel Grant ($2 \times$ USD 500), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Research & Graduate Studies Dissertation Award (USD 7,500), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Travel Grant ($2 \times$ USD 500), Pennsylvania State University, 2025

Finalist for the Neil Wallace Best Third-Year Paper Award, Pennsylvania State University, 2025

Graduate Fellowship, Pennsylvania State University, 2022 – 2026

Young Researcher Award, Argentine Association of Political Economy, 2021

Graduate Fellowship, Universidad de San Andres, 2020

Academic Excellence Award *magna cum laude*, Universidad de Buenos Aires, 2019

Research Assistantship, Universidad de Buenos Aires, 2018 – 2019